ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Betty Renshaw	A retelling of the Buddha's teaching.
2	**(c)** a handful of mustard seed	From a house where no one had died.
3	**(b)** a religious talk	A speech on religion.
4	**(a)** sorrow	Attachment causes suffering.
5	**(b)** Gautama Buddha	The Buddha.
6	**(c)** where no one had died	No death had touched the family.
7	**(b)** having lost a loved one	Grieving.
8	**(b)** Varanasi	Ancient city on the Ganga.
9	**(a)** every house had lost someone	Death comes to all.
10	**(c)** a test to teach a truth	It makes her discover.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A young mother (1) whose only son had died and who was overcome by grief (1).	1+1
12	She realised that death comes to all (1) and she was not alone in her grief (1).	1+1
13	It does not bring the dead back (1) and only increases one's own suffering (1).	1+1
14	She wanted medicine to revive her dead son (1) and was told that the Buddha could help (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She was heartbroken (1). She could not accept the death (1). She wandered asking for medicine (1).	1+1+1
16	It is a form of teaching by experience (1). It spares the mourner's feelings (1). It leads to lasting understanding (1).	1+1+1
17	People still face loss (1). Acceptance helps healing (1). Compassion supports the bereaved (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He listened with kindness (1). He asked for mustard seed from a house free of death (1). He used this to teach her the truth (1).	1+1+1
18	Life is full of problems (1). It is short (1). Death comes to all (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The Buddha told her to bring him a handful of mustard seed (1). The imperative becomes an infinitive (1). Pronouns change (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Her son dies (1). She seeks medicine (1). Buddha asks for mustard seed (1). She finds none (1). She accepts the truth (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). She asks for medicine (1). Buddha asks for mustard seed (1). She returns (1). Understanding (1).	2+2+1
20	He listened (1). He set the mustard seed task (1). She found death in every house (1). She realised its universality (1). She found peace (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Buddha's gentleness (1). Neighbours' sympathy (1). Her own change (1). Teaching by kindness (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Kisa Gotami got medicine from the Buddha; he asked her for **a handful of mustard seed** from a house where no one had died.
- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
- Not stating the final message: *life is full of suffering and death*, and peace comes from giving up grief and attachment.
- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** attaining enlightenment	Buddha means 'the enlightened one'.
2	**(c)** death is the fate of all living beings	She understood the universality of death.
3	**(c)** compassion	Karuna, compassion.
4	**(d)** Bodh Gaya	Under the Bodhi tree.
5	**(c)** buried her son and returned to the Buddha	She gained peace.
6	**(a)** we must accept the reality of death	Acceptance.
7	**(b)** Sarnath near Benares	Deer Park, Sarnath.
8	**(c)** indirect and compassionate	He allowed her to discover the truth.
9	**(d)** calm and wise	A serene teaching.
10	**(a)** Kisa Gotami	Her son had died.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She buried her son (1) and went back to the Buddha with peace of mind (1).	1+1
12	Accept the reality of death (1) and free yourself from grief (1).	1+1
13	A handful of mustard seed (1) from a house where no one had ever died (1).	1+1
14	He knew that there was no medicine for death (1) and wished her to learn the truth herself (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Mustard seed is common in houses (1). The condition was impossible (1). The failure of the search would teach her (1).	1+1+1
16	Grief harms the body and mind (1). It does not help the dead (1). The wise do not grieve (1).	1+1+1
17	Every house was searched by Kisa Gotami (1). The object becomes subject (1). Past passive (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She knocked at many doors (1). Everyone had lost someone (1). Her hope turned into understanding (1).	1+1+1
18	Pull out the arrow of sorrow (1). Accept the truth (1). Live calmly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The Buddha gave a sermon at Sarnath (1). The bereaved mother found peace (1). Both words are used in context (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	A loving mother (1). Overcome by grief (1). Persistent (1). Capable of learning (1). Finds peace (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Kisa Gotami (1). Buddha's lesson (1). Our own examples (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Death is certain (1). Grief is useless (1). Accept reality (1). Show compassion (1). Peace comes from wisdom (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Experience-based (1). Gentle (1). Allows self-discovery (1). Uses simple means (1). Effective result (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Kisa Gotami got medicine from the Buddha; he asked her for **a handful of mustard seed** from a house where no one had died.
- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
- Not stating the final message: *life is full of suffering and death*, and peace comes from giving up grief and attachment.
- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** common to all and cannot be avoided	All must die.
2	**(d)** Kisa Gotami was taught by the Buddha.	Past passive.
3	**(d)** only son	Her child died.
4	**(d)** cannot bring back the dead and harms the mourner	It only causes more pain.
5	**(b)** immortal	Mortal = subject to death.
6	**(a)** medicine to bring her son back to life	She thought he could be revived.
7	**(a)** earthen vessels made by a potter, which all end by being broken	All earthen vessels made by the potter end by being broken, so is the life of mortals.
8	**(d)** pity and kindness	Sympathy.
9	**(d)** a man who recognised her sorrow	A man told her only the Buddha could help.
10	**(c)** pull out the arrow of grief	Remove the dart of sorrow.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Near Benares (1) at Sarnath (1).	1+1
12	In every home someone had died (1) so the Buddha's condition could not be met (1).	1+1
13	Death is certain for all (1) rich or poor, young or old (1).	1+1
14	It gives the Buddha's teaching (1) delivered in the Benares region (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Death is universal (1). Her grief was not special (1). She should accept the truth (1).	1+1+1
16	All things are temporary (1). Death is part of life (1). Accepting this leads to peace (1).	1+1+1
17	Death spares no one (1). It treats all alike (1). So we are equal before it (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He did not scold her (1). He guided her gently (1). He helped her find peace (1).	1+1+1
18	It cannot revive the dead (1). It increases pain (1). It disturbs the mind (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She returned calmly (1). She had buried her son (1). She had learnt the truth (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Address and date (1). Sympathy (1). Share comfort (1). Words of acceptance (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). Her grief (1). The search (1). The realisation (1). Her peace (1).	2+2+1
20	Death comes to all (1). Rich or poor (1). Kisa Gotami's search (1). Equality before death (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Loss is universal (1). Grief needs healing (1). Acceptance (1). Compassion (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Kisa Gotami got medicine from the Buddha; he asked her for **a handful of mustard seed** from a house where no one had died.
- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
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- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

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